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Disability Living Allowance (DLA) for adults

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If you already get DLA

If you were born on or before 8 April 1948, you'll continue to get DLA as long as you're eligible for it.

If you were born after 8 April 1948, your DLA will end. You'll get a letter telling you when that will happen. You'll continue to get DLA until that date.

Unless your circumstances change, you do not need to do anything until you get this letter.

If your DLA claim is ending

If your DLA is ending, you'll get a letter inviting you to apply for Personal Independence Payment (PIP) (/pip). If you do apply, you'll need to do it within 28 days.

DLA will continue to be paid until at least 28 days after a decision is made about your PIP application.

If you're eligible for PIP, you'll start getting PIP payments as soon as your DLA payments end.

Change of circumstances

You must contact the Disability Service Centre (/disability-benefits-helpline) if your circumstances change, as this may affect how much DLA you get. For example:

- the level of help you need or your condition changes
- you go into hospital or a care home for more than 2 days
- a medical professional has said you're nearing the end of life (/benefits-end-of-life) (for example, because of a life-limiting illness)
- you plan to go abroad for more than 4 weeks
- you're imprisoned or held in detention

You must also contact the centre if:

- you change your name, address or bank details
- you want to stop receiving your benefit
- your doctor's details change

You may be asked to claim Personal Independence Payment (PIP) (/pip) after you report a change to your circumstances.

If you go into a care home for more than 2 days, you'll also need to report if:

- there's a change to the way your care home fees are funded (for example, you start or stop getting funding from the NHS or local council)
- you were staying in the care home temporarily and you become a permanent resident
- you move to another care home
- you go into hospital

You could be taken to court or have to pay a penalty if you give wrong information or do not report a change in your circumstances.

If you move from England or Wales to Scotland

If you get DLA and move from England or Wales to Scotland, you must:

- tell DWP (/disability-service-centre) that you have moved
- contact Social Security Scotland (https://www.mygov.scot/contact-social-security-scotland) to find out what benefit you may be eligible to claim

DWP will write to tell you what will happen to your DLA.

Call DWP as soon as you move to Scotland. If you do not, your payments could be affected.

If you move from Scotland to England or Wales

If you get Scottish Adult Disability Living Allowance, you must:

- tell Social Security Scotland (https://www.mygov.scot/moving-to-scottish-adult-dla) that you have moved
- contact the Disability Service Centre (/disability-benefits-helpline) to find out what benefit you may be eligible to claim

Social Security Scotland will tell you when your Scottish Adult Disability Living Allowance will stop.

Call the Disability Service Centre as soon as you move to England or Wales. If you do not, your payments could be affected.

If you've been paid too much DLA

You may have to repay the money if you:

- did not report a change straight away
- gave wrong information
- were overpaid by mistake

Find out how to repay the money you owe from benefit overpayment (/benefit-overpayments).

If you disagree with a decision

You can challenge a decision (/mandatory-reconsideration) about your DLA claim. This is called asking for 'mandatory reconsideration'.

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